

Matthias Ellery

Character Dossier

Stubborn, principled and tired scout of Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity

Overview

Matthias Ellery is a scout living in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity. Matthias is 70 years old, originally from Greywater, and is known around the Undermarket as stubborn, principled and tired. In conversation Matthias gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Background

Matthias arrived in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity 11 years ago after leaving Greywater under circumstances Matthias describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Halcyon Syndicate; the second was the one that stuck. Today Matthias works as a scout near Sector 9 transit hub and is paid, when paid at all, in meridian scrip.

Matthias learned the trade from Farida Lindqvist, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Matthias's life is with Zubair Ironside, over a matter neither will explain. The person Matthias trusts most is Zeph Norwood.

Current goal: to be trusted by the Halcyon Syndicate again. Greatest fear: mirrors in the dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: stubborn, principled and tired.

Speech pattern: Matthias gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Tells: when lying, Matthias mentions Grumble the hedgehog for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Matthias Ellery
Role	scout
Home	Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity
Hometown	Greywater
Age	70
Favourite dish	festival eel pie
Pet	Grumble, a hedgehog
Lucky number	343

<i>Workshop password</i>	ewe-birch
<i>Mentor</i>	Farida Lindqvist
<i>Rival</i>	Zubair Ironside
<i>Closest friend</i>	Zeph Norwood

Secret

Matthias sold a family heirloom to pay for Zeph Norwood's medicine and told everyone it was stolen.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Matthias: I am the scout. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Matthias: Festival eel pie. Do not tell Zubair I said so.

Visitor: Is Grumble yours?

Matthias: Grumble belongs to nobody. Grumble tolerates me. Lucky number is 343, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 6

Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Matthias has a suspect and is probably right. Matthias won 51 meridian scrip on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on supper. Matthias won 34 meridian scrip on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on supper. Matthias repaired the ledger at the Undermarket for Delphine, who paid in 58 meridian scrip and a long story about the quarantine. Matthias found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the Undermarket and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 2, winter of year 6

The weather turned. Matthias moved the pair of spectacles indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. Matthias found a grain scale half-buried near the Undermarket and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Percival came by asking about the new curfew. Matthias said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 3, spring of year 6

Ulla came by asking about the tariff on salt. Matthias said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Matthias moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the price of lamp oil. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached Sector 9 transit hub. Matthias pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached Sector 9 transit hub. Matthias pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Matthias moved the oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the harvest count.